

options. And these options may not be optimally configured for your needs. So you're going to want to take the time to walk through these steps, once each for each of your configured email accounts. It's a bit monotonous if you have multiple accounts. But you'll agree it's worth it when you discover, say, that one of your accounts isn't even automatically downloading mail to the phone. You can configure an individual email account in one of two ways. The most obvious is to navigate to **All Programs > Settings > Email & Accounts**, and then pick the account you wish to modify.



Configuring Outlook

Or, instead of that first way, you can manually launch one of your email accounts, either via its Start screen-based live tile, or from within the All Programs list. Then, tap the More button and choose Settings. This will display the Email Account Settings screen. Why go through this convoluted process? Because this screen has a single, additional option you won't find if you try to configure the account through the Email & Settings interface: Use an Email Signature. If you want to change this from the default option – Sent from Windows Phone – or, more likely, just want to turn it off, you can do so right here. You never would have found this option if you had gone with Plan A.

With that out of the way, tap the giant Sync Settings button. This will display a more complete Settings screen. This has a wide range of configurable options, much of which is obvious. But there are a couple options that are quite important and quite possibly are misconfigured. These are:

- ▶ **Download new content:** This option determines how frequently the phone synchronizes with the email server. The possibilities vary here from account type to account type. For example, for Yahoo! Mail, you can only choose between every 15 minutes, every 30 minutes, hourly, every 2 hours, and manually. (And, oddly, for Yahoo! Mail, every 2 hours is the default.) More sophisticated e-mail services those that offer “push” e-mail support through Exchange ActiveSync and similar technologies will offer an additional choice, as items arrive. This is the optimal choice for these types of accounts, which include Windows Live, Outlook, and Google.